

The Sicilian creates an imbalance

Opening Decisions

THE IDEA

After 1.e4 c5, Black challenges d4 from the flank rather than mirroring White's e-pawn. In many open Sicilian structures, Black's c-pawn trades for White's d-pawn. That changes central pawn numbers and opens the c-file.

WORKED EXAMPLE

After 1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 d6 3.d4 cxd4 4.Nxd4, White develops quickly while Black has two central pawns against White's e-pawn. These features explain competing plans but do not decide the position alone.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What file becomes half-open for Black after the sample exchange?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The c-file: Black's c-pawn has left it while White usually retains a c-pawn. Rook pressure there can become useful after development. White may seek initiative before Black coordinates.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Connect an opening's pawn trade to its later plans.